

9.4 Using The Task Manager

Task Manager provides information about programs and processes running on your computer. It also displays the most commonly used performance measures for processes. In earlier versions of Windows, pressing [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Del] was the last resort if something went wrong. Windows XP doesn't crash nearly as often, and pressing [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Del] brings up the Task Manager. With the Task Manager, you can kill (terminate) offending processes, amongst other things.

You can use Task Manager to monitor key indicators of your computer's performance. You can see the status of the programs that are running and end programs that have stopped responding.

You can also assess the activity of running processes using as many as fifteen parameters, and see graphs and data on CPU and memory usage. In addition, if you are connected to a network, you can view network status and see how your network is functioning. If you have more than one user connected to your computer, you can see who is connected, what they are working on, and you can send them a message.



The Applications tab of the Task Manager

The most common use for the Task Manager is to kill processes. The need for this arises in several situations: if a program is not responding, you might need to open the Task